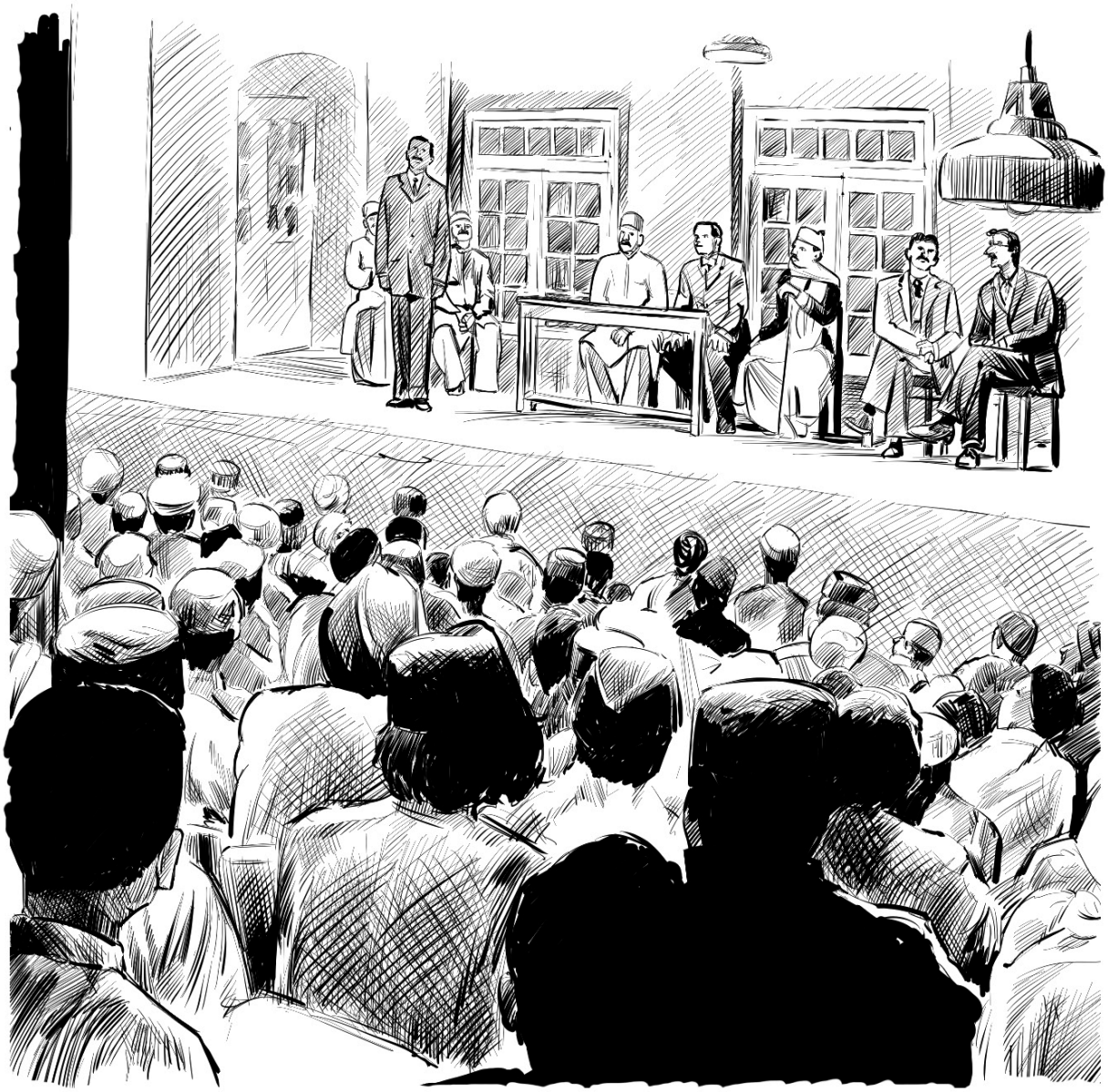


When Gandhi finally arrived in Pretoria, he called the Indian community together for a meeting. He could no longer be timid. “My speech at this meeting may be said to have been the first public speech in my life,” he said. He shared his ideas about how Indians could improve their lives. He spoke about the need for fair treatment of Indians in South Africa. He knew he could go back to India. Or he could stand up for his rights, and the rights of Indians in South Africa. He decided to stay.